

SLOVENIA AND CROATIA

THE COUNTRIES of Slovenia and Croatia stretch from the snow-clad Alps in the north to the sunny Adriatic coast in the south. The area is crossed by the Sava River, which flows past the capital cities of Ljubljana and Zagreb, across a fertile plain, eventually joining the Danube. In the west the Karst region of Slovenia has given its name to a type of scenery associated with limestone rock formations and deep caves. Some caves, such as those at Postojna, are as large as cathedrals. Ruled by Austria and Hungary for centuries, both countries retain strong cultural ties with Europe. At the end of World War I, Slovenia and Croatia were incorporated into the newly formed Yugoslavia but declared themselves independent in 1991.



WALLED CITY OF DUBROVNIK

This ancient Croatian port, with its narrow streets and massive walls, was founded by the Romans in the 7th century. Protected by its fortifications, Dubrovnik grew into a thriving city with trade links throughout the region. The wealth brought by trade encouraged a strong artistic tradition which persists today. Most of the damage from the war in the 1990s has now been repaired.

